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Sunday

PM departs for SCO Summit

Says looking to advance India's vision for region free from terror

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Travel Page18

Golden lure

New Zealand's west coast is not just about nature's treasures such as rainforests and glaciers but also its goldmines

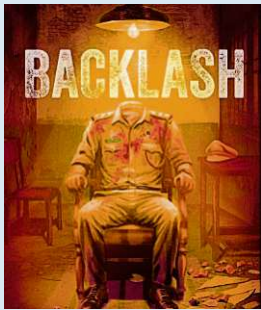
Art & Pursuits Page20



Lines and rhythms

Botticelli, one of the most creative painters of the Renaissance, faded from public memory and was rediscovered later

Books Page17



Powerful and damned

This is an ambitious novel that focuses on the imbalance between those who hold power and those who face its consequences

Food & Drink Page19



Serving contrasts

From sweet and savoury pastilla to meat with prunes and mint tea, Moroccan cuisine is a medley of influences

Quickly



Will give new shape to Dasara: CM

Chief Minister D K Shivakumar said that he plans to give new shape to Mysuru Dasara in keeping with the changing times and make it more attractive with new innovations and events for people from across the country and the globe who come to see Dasara which is of international fame.

Details on Page 7

VTU gets back funds seized by I-T dept

After fourteen years of battle with the Income Tax department Visvesvaraya Technological University has got back corpus funds worth more than Rs 600 crore seized by the department in 2012-13 for non payment of tax. After series of court cases, VTU finally got relief using the Right to Information Act (RTI).

Details on Page 6

FDA drops order against Cipla, MCA

The Bombay High Court on Saturday dealt a double blow to the Maharashtra FDA, forcing the regulator to backtrack on cancelling the drug sale licence of Cipla Pharma and its order in connection with eateries on the Mumbai Cricket Association premises.

HDFC Bank CEO Jagdishan opts to retire

HDFC Bank's managing director and chief executive Sashidhar Jagdishan on Saturday opted out of being considered for reappointment after his current term ends on October 26, the largest private sector lender said in a regulatory filing. Jagdishan (61), will retire from the bank on October 26 after spending nearly three decades at the lender.

After taking over as the bank CEO in October 2020, Jagdishan is serving his second three-year term as the lender's head.

The HDFC Bank board will fast-track the process for selection and appointment of Jagdishan's successor "well within time", the exchange filing said.

Russia strike on Kyiv arms depot kills 37

Russia struck an arms depot near Kyiv overnight, sparking fires and explosions that killed 37 people and wounded dozens of others, authorities said Saturday. AFP reporters saw plumes of black smoke over the capital's western suburbs, while videos published by Ukraine's rescue services showed firefighters battling a large blaze overnight.

From celluloid to digital: Saving India's films before the reels fade

As the country's vast cinematic heritage faces decay, archivists work against time to preserve, restore and make its films accessible to future generations

PRANATI A S BENGALURU, DHNS

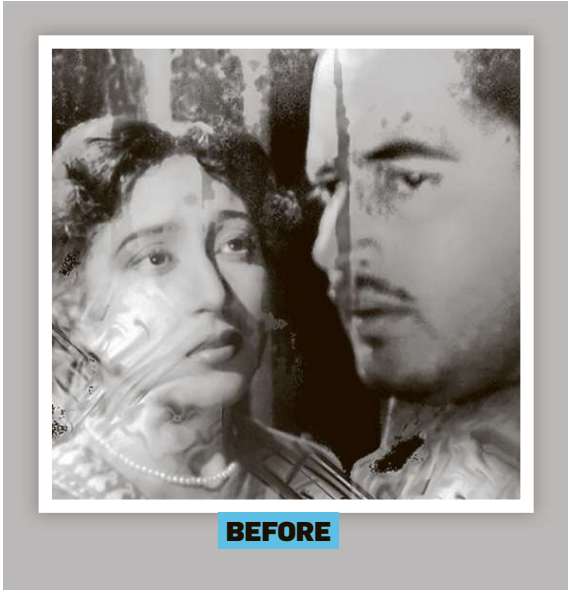
The iconic Bengaluru petes, the bustling Bombay tramways and the elegant promenades of Kolkata are spaces of a bygone era that can now be glimpsed in films like 'Mayor Muthanna' (1969), 'CID' (1956) and 'Seemabaddha' (1971). As modern infrastructure systematically paves over history, celluloids have quietly become faithful historians. Films also preserve the sounds of the past, the din of early industrial factories, the whistles of obsolete steam locomotives and the songs of birds that are now extinct.

Across the world, governments are actively undertaking film digitisation and restoration projects. As filmmaking

INSIGHT

moved from labour-intensive analogue productions to simpler digital formats, preserving the celluloids of the past that are prone to deterioration and physical decay has become more urgent than ever.

"Pain is temporary, film is permanent," says filmmaker Imtiaz Ali. "Our filmmakers toiled endlessly, endured much because



BEFORE



AFTER

Guru Dutt's iconic film Pyaasa (1957) was restored and re-released in theatres across India in 2025.

they held that belief. We have to act now to uphold their principle. Great cinema has great value for a healthy society," he says, highlighting the importance of film restoration.

The National Film Archive of India (NFAI) was established in Pune in 1964. The institution, which later joined the International Federation of Film Archives has been archiving Indian and world cinema, including material dating back to the silent film era. Its vast collection spans film prints, cell negatives, video cassettes

and DVDs.

Since the 1970s and 80s, India has been the largest film producing country in the world, making more than 2,500 movies a year in over 20 languages. Film archivist Aparna Subramanian, who has visited film archives across Southeast Asia, says Indian archives are estimated to hold nearly three times as much celluloid material as comparable archives in Malaysia and Thailand.

With a vast film industry, India also faces significant challenges in preserving and archiving its cinematic

heritage. The country's tropical climate is one of the major obstacles to analogue film preservation, which requires carefully controlled temperature and humidity, along with proper storage facilities. In 2003, a fire at NFAI Pune destroyed several films. Reports suggested that a possible failure of the air-conditioning system caused the room temperature to rise. At the time, the archive still held a large quantity of nitrate-based film stock, which is highly unstable, flammable and prone to chemical

self-combustion.

In 2015, the government set up the National Film Heritage Mission to upgrade archiving and restoration facilities at NFAI and to scale up slow, localised efforts into a fast-tracked, heavily funded national framework.

Legal deposit system

Another drawback, Aparna points out, is the absence of a legal deposit system for films, leaving neither state archives nor the national archive with a comprehensive collection of films. "That is something a

policy needs to address," she says. Archivist P K Nair, one of the first archivists at NFAI, had tried to propose a legal deposit system, but it did not materialise. A legal film deposit is a statutory requirement mandating filmmakers to submit copies of their certified films to a designated national or state archive.

Although the NFAI restores films in all languages, one national archive is not sufficient to preserve the cinematic heritage of a country as vast and diverse as India. "Language-wise, we will come across difficulties. If the archive is based in Pune, how do we deal with material in a northeastern language," says Aparna, adding, "There are issues of storage, cataloguing and metadata as well."

Some states have regional archives or film corporations, but these bodies need to more actively engage in the archival process, build infrastructure for restoration, hold training programmes and organise capacity building courses on preservation, archiving, digitisation and restoration.

The Karnataka state archives at the Karnataka Chalanachitra Academy have 68 analogue films and 98 U-matic tapes. ► Film restoration, Page 4

Agnipath faces a crucial test as first batch nears exit

With Agniveers completing their four-year tenure, questions mount over what lies ahead for the 75% who will leave the armed forces

KALYAN RAY

What will happen to the Agniveers after they leave the service at the end of their four-year tenure? While up to 25% of each batch will be retained in the armed forces, the remaining 75% will have to transition to civilian livelihoods. With less than 100 days left for the first batch recruited under the Agnipath scheme to exit the military and explore alternative livelihoods, questions remain over the future of these short-term soldiers who served shoulder to shoulder with regular troops whenever the opportunity arose.

Will those who leave the military find jobs in some other uniformed service? Will their seniority be recognised in those services? How will the 25% be selected to serve as regular personnel for another 15 years? Is the tax-free Seva Nidhi exit package of Rs 12 lakh sufficient for those who leave after four years? Could they be retained for longer? And how useful will the government-issued skill certificates be in an increasingly competitive and shrinking job market?

The government has opened up a few avenues, no doubt. The Union Ministry of Home Affairs



The first batch of Agniveers is less than 100 days away from completing its four-year service. In pic, Agniveers undergo training in Bengaluru. DH PHOTO/KRISHNAMKUMAR P S

created a new category of Ex-Agniveer for the recruitment of Constable (General Duty)/ Rifleman in the Central Armed Police Forces and Assam Rifles and reserved 50% of vacancies for them, besides

examination. A dedicated desk has been created at the Home Ministry to assist Agniveers.

Other ministries and state governments have also created job quotas for Ex-Agniveers. The Railways has committed to a horizontal reservation of 10% in direct recruitment from the open market for Pay Level-1 posts and 5% for Pay Level-2 and above posts in various departments, other than Railway Protection Force and Railway Protection Special Force (RPF/RPSF), for Agniveers. A 10% horizontal reservation is also provided for Constable posts in the RPF/RPSF. In both categories, age relaxations have been provided.



providing three years of age relaxation for Agniveers and five years for the first batch. They have also been exempted from the physical standards test, physical efficiency test and written

Grand Dasara, little reward for its folk artists

SHILPA P MYSURU, DHNS

For thousands of folk artists, performing in the Mysuru Dasara Jamboo Savari is a matter of pride and devotion. But behind the grandeur, many complain of low remuneration and inadequate basic facilities.

According to the Dasara committee, around 1,500 folk artists from across the state present more than 60 folk art forms in Mysuru on the Vijayadashami day. During the Jamboo Savari, they perform non-stop for nearly four hours.

"Despite our long hours of performance, we are not even paid one-third of what we receive for an hour-long performance at a village fair," said a veteran artist.

According to the Dasara audits, the government spent Rs 43 crore on Dasara in 2025 and Rs 42 crore in 2024. As per officials, Bollywood and Sandalwood actors and their troupes performing at Yuva Dasara were paid between Rs 1.5 crore and Rs 3.5 crore, while artists performing in front of the palace received between Rs 1.5 lakh and Rs 20 lakh. However, last year, folk artists participating in the Jamboo Savari received Rs 875 per person per day for two days, irrespective of their seniority or the art form they perform.

The Department of Kannada and Culture's guidelines, last revised in 2016, prescribe Rs 20,000 a day for a team of at least eight artists for performances elsewhere. This works out to Rs 2,500 per artist, nearly three times what they receive for the Dasara procession.

Many artists, speaking on condition of anonymity, said the low remuneration was making it increasingly difficult for them to meet their basic expenses. "We only ask to be treated with some dignity and paid at least Rs 3,000 to Rs 5,000 per person a day. Once we enter the palace premises by noon, we are not



Folk artists perform during the Dasara Jamboo Savari in Mysuru. DH FILE PHOTO

even given food," said a Tamate artist from Mysuru.

A Lambani artist from Bidar said many performers depended entirely on their art for their livelihood, while others worked as daily wagers. "It takes days to recover after the hectic performance in Mysuru," she said.

The cost of putting up a performance is another burden for many artists. A Huli Vesha artist from Udupi said his group spent around Rs 2 lakh last year on paint, a generator and travel expenses.

Inadequate funds

A senior officer from the Department of Kannada and Culture said the department receives around 800 applications for the procession but can accommodate only about 60 teams.

"The allocation for folk artists is around Rs 50 lakh, of which about Rs 20 lakh is for remuneration and the rest for food, accommodation and transportation. This is not sufficient to accommodate such a large group," the officer said.

Gollahalli Shivaprasad, Chairperson of the Karnataka Janapada Academy, said, "I will discuss with officials of Department of Kannada and Culture and chief minister the need to ensure dignified treatment and decent remuneration for folk artists."